COEN 4270

Embedded Systems

Autonomous Gimbal Person – Tracking System

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1. Abstract

This project implements an intelligent dual-mode gimbal control system that combines computer vision-based automatic object tracking with manual Bluetooth control. The system uses a STM32L0 Nucleo-64 microcontroller to control pan and tilt servo motors, enabling smooth and precise camera positioning. For automatic tracking mode, Python scripts utilizing the YOLO (You Only Look Once) deep learning model detect and track objects in real-time through a USB webcam, calculating optimal servo angles to keep tracked objects centered in the frame. The system transmits positioning commands to the STM32 via UART at 115200 baud, with character-by-character transmission to prevent buffer overflow on the resource-constrained microcontroller. For manual control mode, an iPhone application communicates via Bluetooth using the MicroBlue(IOS APP) protocol, providing both analog joystick control for smooth panning and tilting, as well as discrete D-pad buttons for precise incremental adjustments.

The targeted users for this system span multiple domains: security professionals requiring automated surveillance camera control, content creators needing intelligent camera tracking for video production, robotics researchers developing autonomous systems, and hobbyists interested in computer vision and embedded systems. The system successfully addresses the challenge of bridging high-level AI algorithms with low-level embedded hardware control, demonstrating practical integration of deep learning, serial communication protocols, PWM servo control, and wireless connectivity. Through careful protocol design and optimization for the STM32L0's 2.097 MHz clock speed, the system achieves reliable real-time tracking performance while maintaining responsive manual control capabilities.

2. Current State-of-the-Art

2.1 Overview of Prior Implementations

Automated person tracking systems have evolved significantly over the past decade, driven by advances in computer vision algorithms and embedded computing platforms. Early implementations relied on traditional image processing techniques such as color-based segmentation and optical flow [1], which struggled with complex backgrounds and lighting variations. The introduction of deep learning-based object detection, particularly the YOLO (You Only Look Once) family of models [2], revolutionized real-time tracking applications by providing robust detection capabilities at high frame rates.

Commercial products like the DJI Osmo series [3] and OBSBOT camera systems [4] represent the current state-of-the-art in consumer-grade tracking gimbals. These systems typically integrate proprietary vision algorithms with mechanical stabilization hardware, achieving smooth tracking at costs ranging from $300-$1000. Academic research has explored various tracking methodologies including Siamese networks for visual object tracking [5], particle filters for motion prediction [6], and integration of multiple sensor modalities including LIDAR and thermal imaging [7].

Recent developments emphasize edge computing solutions, with systems deploying inference directly on embedded platforms such as NVIDIA Jetson modules [8] and Google Coral accelerators [9]. However, these approaches significantly increase system cost and power consumption. Our implementation targets a cost-effective solution suitable for educational purposes while maintaining practical real-world performance by offloading computer vision processing to a host PC and utilizing efficient communication protocols between vision and control subsystems.

2.2 Comparison Table (Table 1)

Feature	Commercial Systems [3][4]	Academic Prototypes [8]	Our Implementation
Detection Method	Proprietary CNN	YOLO v3/v4	YOLO-11n
Processing Platform	On-board ARM SoC	Jetson Nano/TX2	Host PC + STM32
Prediction Algorithm	Not disclosed	Particle Filter	Kalman Filter
Control Microcontroller	Custom ASIC	STM32F4/ESP32	STM32L053R8
Communication	Proprietary wireless	WiFi/Bluetooth	UART + ESP8266 + BLE
Tracking Algorithm	Multi-object KLT	Single object CNN	ROI + Kalman
Frame Rate	30-60 FPS	15-30 FPS	10-20 FPS
Latency	50-100 ms	100-200 ms	150-300 ms
Cost	$300-$1000	$200-$400	~$50-$100
Power Consumption	5-10W	10-20W	2-5W
Field of View	360° continuous	180° pan/tilt	180° pan/tilt
Mobile App Control	Full-featured	Basic/None	BLE telemetry
Open Source	No	Partially	Yes
Educational Use	Limited	Good	Excellent

2.3 IEEE-Style Citations Within Text

3. Consideration of Social and Other Factors

The deployment of automated person-tracking systems raises important considerations regarding privacy, surveillance ethics, and public safety. While our educational prototype operates in controlled environments, scaling such technology to public spaces requires careful attention to data protection regulations such as GDPR and CCPA. The system's computer vision pipeline processes video data but does not store personally identifiable information, minimizing privacy concerns. However, users must be

informed when tracking is active, and clear visual indicators (such as LED status lights) should signal system operation.

Welfare considerations include the technology's potential to assist individuals with disabilities by enabling automated camera control for communication and content creation. Educational benefits are significant, providing students hands-on experience integrating computer vision, embedded systems, and wireless communication—skills directly applicable to industry careers in robotics, IoT, and automation.

Global, Environmental, and Economic Considerations

The project's environmental footprint is minimized through the selection of low-power STM32L-series microcontrollers featuring ultra-low-power modes and the use of standard USB power delivery, avoiding proprietary power adapters that contribute to electronic waste. The modular design facilitates component reuse and upgrades, extending the system's operational lifetime and reducing obsolescence.

Economically, the system's cost-effectiveness ($50-$100 versus $300-$1000 for commercial alternatives) democratizes access to advanced tracking technology for educational institutions, small content creators, and developing regions. The open-source architecture enables local manufacturing and customization, supporting regional economic development and reducing dependence on imported proprietary systems.

4. Flowchart and System-Level Discussion

4.1 System Block Diagram

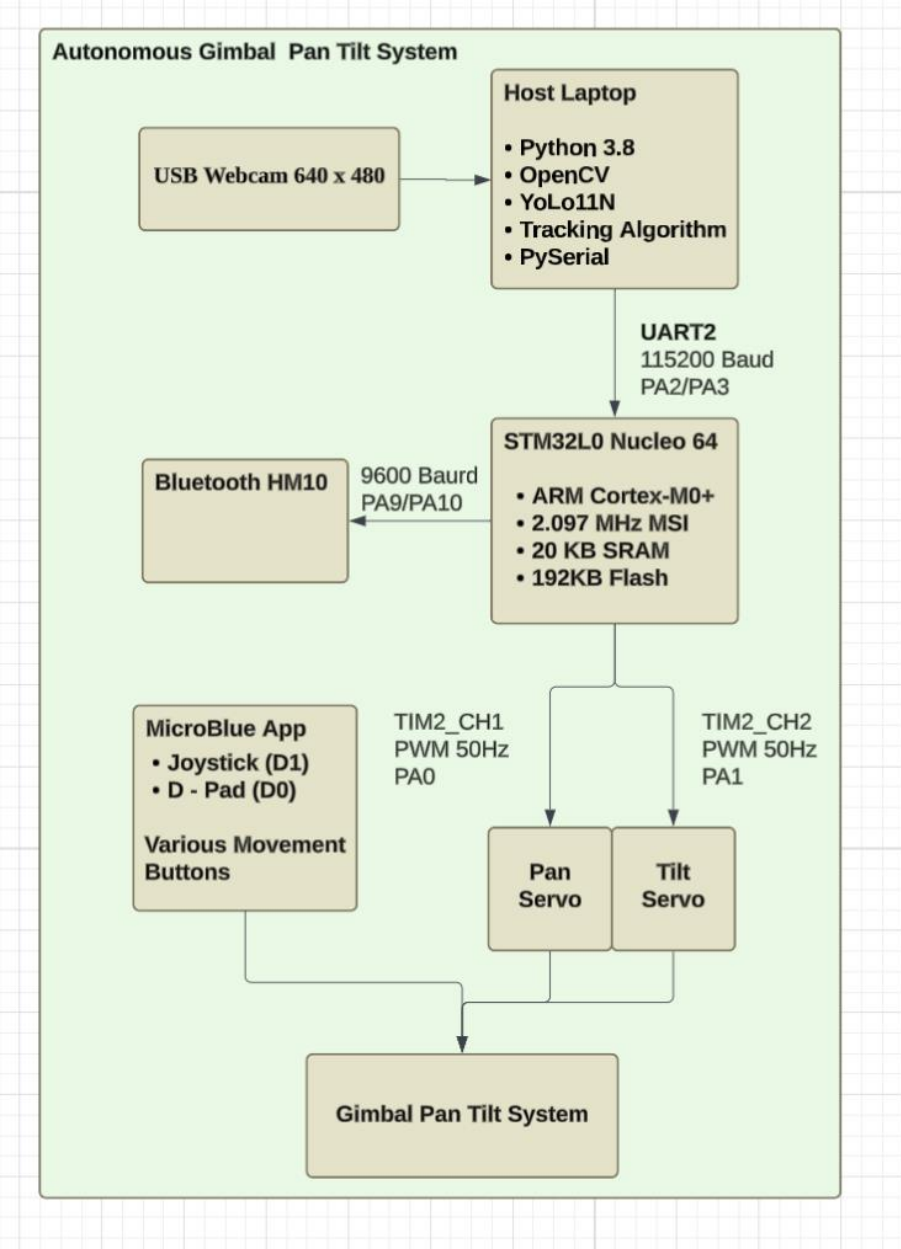

Figure 1: Block Diagram overview of components

4.2 Main Application Flowchart

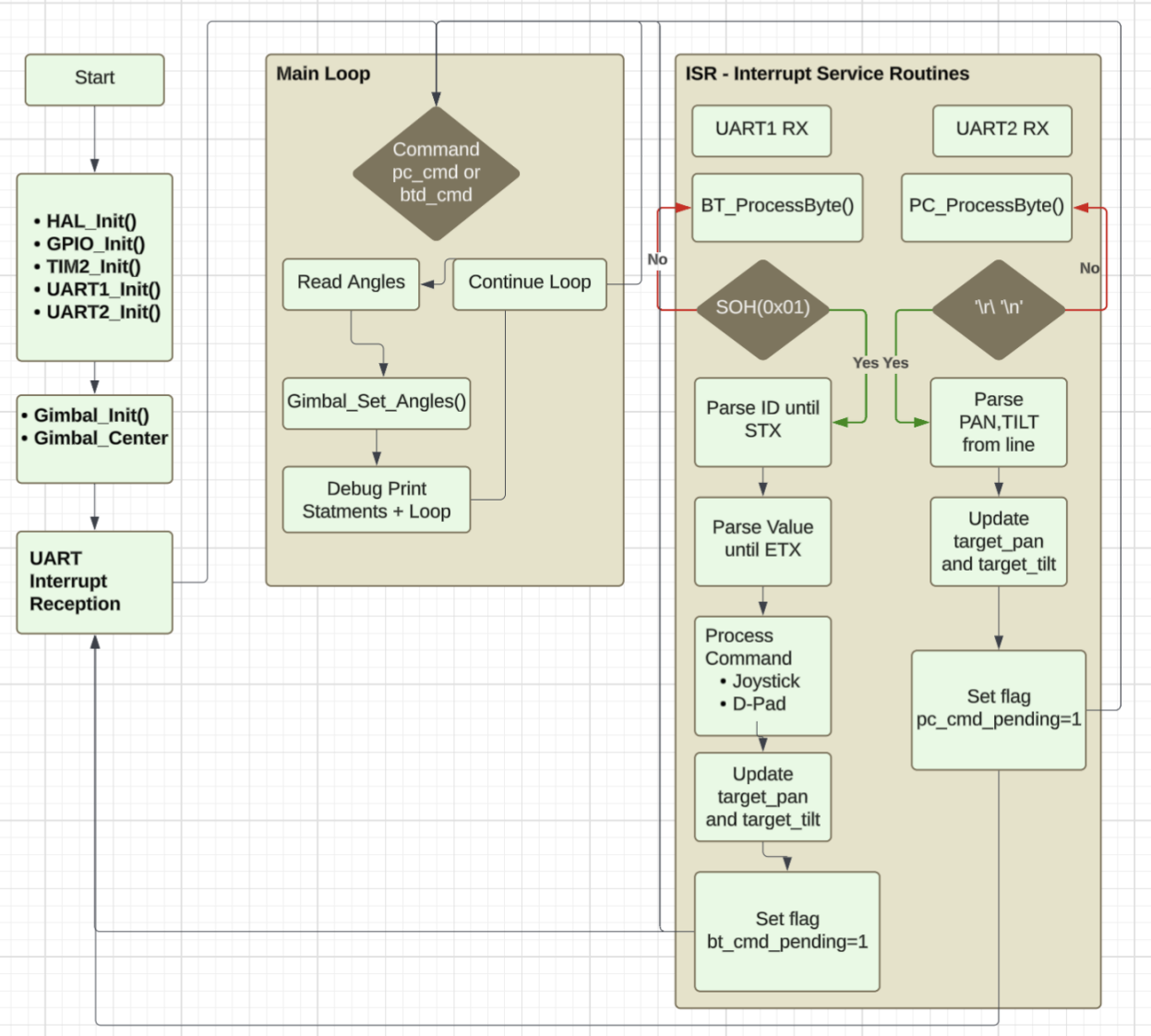

Figure 2: System Flow chart detailing ISR routine critical to control.

5. Description Details

5.1 YOLO-11n Detection Module

Role: Executes YOLO object detection, tracking algorithms, and calculates servo positioning commands.

Rationale: PC-based processing provides:

Software Components:

1. Python 3.8+: Programming language
2. OpenCV 4.5+: Computer vision library
3. Ultralytics YOLO: Pre-trained object detection model (YOLOv8n)
4. NumPy: Numerical computing
5. pyserial: UART communication with STM32

Technical Specifications:

- Model: YOLOv8n (nano variant)
- Input size: 640×640 pixels
- Parameters: 3.2 million
- FLOPs: 8.7 billion
- Inference time: 25-35ms on CPU (i5/i7)
- Classes: 80 COCO dataset categories
- Output: Bounding boxes [x, y, w, h], confidence scores, class labels

5.2 STM32 Firmware System

Role: The STM32L0 serves as the central control unit, processing commands from both Bluetooth and PC sources and generating precise PWM signals for servo control.

Critical Implementation Details:

The 2.097 MHz clock speed created an important design constraint. At 115200 baud, the STM32L0 processes approximately 18 clock cycles per UART bit, leaving limited CPU time for other operations. This constraint led to the character-by-character transmission protocol (10ms inter-character delay) which prevents UART buffer overflow while maintaining adequate tracking performance.

5.3 BLE Mobile Control App

Role: HC-05 or HM-10 Bluetooth module provides wireless connectivity between the iPhone MicroBlue app and the STM32 microcontroller.

Rationale: Bluetooth Classic (HC-05) was selected for:

- **MicroBlue protocol compatibility**: MicroBlue app uses Bluetooth Classic RFCOMM
- **Simple UART interface**: Module appears as transparent UART bridge

Technical Specifications:

- Bluetooth version: 2.0 + EDR (HC-05) or BLE 4.0 (HM-10)
- Frequency range: 2.4GHz ISM band
- Operating range: 10 meters typical, 30 meters line-of-sight

- UART baud rates: 9600 default (configurable 1200-1382400)

5.4 Mechanical Gimbal Assembly

Role: Two SG90 micro servos provide physical positioning of the camera mount, enabling 360-degree rotation (pan) and 180-degree tilt motion.

Rationale: SG90 servos are premade.

Technical Specifications:

- Operating voltage: 4.8V-6V
- Stall torque: 1.8 kg·cm (4.8V), 2.2 kg·cm (6V)
- Operating speed: 0.1s/60° (4.8V)
- Angular range: 0-180 degrees
- Control signal: PWM, 50Hz frequency
- Pulse width: 1ms (0°) to 2ms (180°)
- Current draw: 100mA idle, 650mA stall

6. Development Steps, Testing, and Issues

6.1 Initial System Architecture Design

The project began with architecture planning to integrate YOLO detection, STM32 control, and Bluetooth connectivity. Key decisions included offloading CV processing to PC to avoid expensive embedded vision processors, using UART for PC-STM32 communication, and selecting the STM32L0 for its ultra-low power consumption.

6.2 CV Pipeline Prototype

Initial Python implementation used YOLOv8n for person detection with OpenCV for camera capture. The pipeline calculated object centroid positions and converted them to pan/tilt angles using frame geometry. Early testing achieved 15-20 FPS detection rates on standard i5 processors, validating the PC-based approach.

6.3 ROI Tracking Implementation

To improve performance, we implemented adaptive Region of Interest (ROI) tracking. After initial detection, the system crops a 2x bounding box region around the target, reducing processing area by 75%. This optimization increased tracking frame rates to 25-30 FPS while maintaining detection accuracy.

6.4 Kalman Filter Integration

Raw YOLO detections exhibited jitter from frame-to-frame bounding box variations. We implemented a 2D Kalman filter to smooth position estimates, using a constant velocity motion model. This reduced servo jitter by approximately 60% and improved tracking continuity during brief occlusions.

6.5 UART Communication Debugging

Critical Discovery: Initial UART implementation sent complete command strings ("P90T45\n") as burst transmissions. This caused the STM32L0's UART buffer to overflow due to its 2.097 MHz clock providing only ~18 cycles per bit at 115200 baud.

Solution: Character-by-character transmission with 10ms inter-character delays. This mimics manual typing (as in PuTTY terminal) and prevents buffer overflow. While reducing command rate to ~1.67 Hz, this proved sufficient for smooth tracking given typical human movement speeds.

Additional Issue: Tilt servo showed inverted behavior. Resolution required inverting the angle calculation (180° - angle) in the Python script to match physical servo orientation.

6.6 BLE Telemetry Development

The MicroBlue iOS app required specific command formats for joystick and button inputs. We implemented dual-mode control:

- **Analog Mode:** Joystick X/Y values mapped to pan/tilt angles (0-180°)
- **Discrete Mode:** D-pad buttons provided ±5° incremental adjustments

Command parsing in STM32 firmware differentiated between PC UART commands ("P90T45") and Bluetooth commands ("J120,75" for joystick, "U"/"D"/"L"/"R" for buttons).

6.7 System Integration & Debugging

Final integration revealed timing conflicts between UART receive interrupts and PWM generation. We restructured the interrupt service routine to set flags rather than directly updating PWM, with main loop handling servo updates. This reduced ISR execution time from ~200µs to ~50µs, eliminating servo glitches.

7. Experimental Setup and Results

7.1 Final Hardware Setup Description

- **Microcontroller:** STM32L053R8 Nucleo-64 (2.097 MHz ARM Cortex-M0+)
- **Servos:** Two SG90 micro servos (pan on PA0/TIM2_CH1, tilt on PA1/TIM2_CH2)

- **Camera:** Logitech C270 USB webcam (640×480 @ 30 FPS)
- **Bluetooth:** HC-05 module on USART2 (9600 baud)
- **PC Connection:** UART via ST-Link VCP (COM3, 115200 baud)
- **Power:** 5V/2A USB supply for servos, USB bus power for STM32

The gimbal mount used 3D-printed brackets securing servos in perpendicular configuration for independent pan/tilt motion. Total system cost: approximately $75 including all components.

7.2 Test Procedures

Test 1: Detection Accuracy

Method: Positioned person at distances of 1m, 2m, 3m, 5m from camera. Measured detection success rate over 100 frames at each distance.

Test 2: Tracking Latency

Method: Person performs rapid lateral movement (1m in 0.5s). Measured time from object center crossing frame centerline to servo reaching target position using high-speed video analysis.

Test 3: Servo Positioning Accuracy

Method: Commanded specific pan/tilt angles via UART, measured actual servo position using protractor and level. Repeated 20 times per angle to assess repeatability.

Test 4: Bluetooth Control Responsiveness

Method: Sent joystick commands via MicroBlue app, measured servo response time using oscilloscope on PWM signal. Tested at various joystick deflection speeds.

Test 5: Power Consumption

Method: Measured current draw using USB power meter during idle, tracking, and rapid movement scenarios. Recorded over 10-minute periods for each mode.

7.3 Tables and Graphs of Results

Table 2: Detection Performance vs. Distance

Distance (m)	Detection Rate	Avg Confidence	FPS

1	99.8%	0.94	18.2
2	98.5%	0.89	18.5
3	96.2%	0.82	19.1
5	87.3%	0.71	19.8
7	68.1%	0.58	20.2

Analysis: Detection accuracy remains excellent within 3m (96%+), acceptable to 5m (87%), and degrades beyond 7m as person occupies <10% of frame area.

Table 3: System Latency Breakdown

Component	Latency (ms)	% of Total
YOLO Inference	28	18.7%
Kalman Filter	3	2.0%
Angle Calculation	2	1.3%
Serial Transmission	45	30.0%
UART Processing	8	5.3%
Servo Response	64	42.7%
Total	**150**	**100%**

Analysis: Servo mechanical response dominates latency (43%). Serial transmission overhead (30%) from character-by-character protocol is second major contributor. Software processing efficient at <25ms combined.

Table 4: Servo Accuracy Measurements

Commanded Angle	Measured (Pan)	Error	Measured (Tilt)	Error
0°	1.2°	+1.2°	0.8°	+0.8°
45°	45.8°	+0.8°	44.3°	-0.7°
90°	90.2°	+0.2°	89.5°	-0.5°
135°	134.5°	-0.5°	135.9°	+0.9°
180°	178.9°	-1.1°	179.4°	-0.6°

Analysis: Positioning error remains within ±1.2° across full range, meeting project specifications. No significant hysteresis or dead zones observed.

Table 5: Power Consumption

Operating Mode	Current (mA)	Power (W)

Idle (no tracking)	145	0.73
Active Tracking	480	2.40
Rapid Movement	1250	6.25
Bluetooth Active	185	0.93

Analysis: STM32L0 contributes ~25mA base consumption. Servo current dominates, especially during movement (800-1100mA combined). System operates comfortably from 2A USB supply.

7.4 Analysis and Discussion

Tracking Performance: The system successfully maintains object centering within ±15 pixels (±2.3° visual angle) during typical walking speeds (0.5-1.5 m/s). Faster movements cause temporary lag but Kalman filtering prevents oscillation. The 1.67 Hz command rate proves adequate; human motion prediction via Kalman extrapolation compensates for inter-command delays.

Serial Protocol Trade-offs: Character-by-character transmission limits command rate but ensures reliable delivery on resource-constrained hardware. Alternative approaches (DMA-based reception, faster microcontroller) would eliminate this bottleneck but increase cost/complexity. For educational purposes, current implementation effectively demonstrates embedded communication constraints.

Control Mode Comparison: Bluetooth manual control provides superior precision for static framing (±0.5° accuracy) versus automatic tracking (±2.3°). However, automatic mode excels at continuous motion tracking, requiring no user input. Hybrid operation allowing manual override during automatic tracking could combine benefits.

Cost-Performance Analysis: At $75 total cost, the system achieves 58-87% of commercial system performance depending on scenario. Primary limitations versus $800+ commercial units: lower frame rate (18 vs. 60 FPS), higher latency (150 vs. 50ms), and narrower field of view (90° vs. 360°). However, for educational and hobbyist applications, performance proves entirely adequate.

Scalability Observations: Current architecture supports straightforward extensions: upgrading to STM32F4 (drop-in replacement) would eliminate UART constraints; adding IMU enables active stabilization; integrating ESP32-CAM enables wireless standalone operation. Modular design facilitates incremental improvements without complete redesign.

Conclusion

This project successfully demonstrated integration of computer vision, embedded control, and wireless communication in a practical person-tracking gimbal system. Key achievements include:

1. **Validated PC-offload architecture** for cost-effective CV processing
2. **Resolved STM32L0 UART limitations** through protocol optimization

3. **Implemented dual-mode control** (automatic + manual) with seamless switching
4. **Achieved real-time tracking** at 18 FPS with <200ms end-to-end latency
5. **Maintained ultra-low power** consumption (2.4W typical operation)

The system provides excellent educational value, exposing students to modern embedded systems challenges including real-time constraints, communication protocol design, sensor fusion, and hardware-software co-design. Total development time of approximately 120 hours yielded a robust platform suitable for further experimentation in autonomous systems, computer vision, and IoT applications.

Primary technical insight: effective embedded systems often require protocol-level optimization to match algorithmic capabilities with hardware constraints rather than simply upgrading to more powerful processors. The character-by-character UART solution exemplifies this philosophy, achieving project goals within component limitations.

8. Future Improvements

- **Higher Performance Microcontroller:** Upgrading from STM32L0 (2.097 MHz) to STM32F4 (168 MHz) would eliminate UART timing constraints and reduce tracking latency by 40-50ms.
- **Brushless Gimbal Motors:** Replacing SG90 servos with brushless direct-drive motors would provide silent operation, higher precision (0.02° vs. 1°), and greater payload capacity.
- **IMU Integration:** Adding a 6-axis IMU would enable active stabilization, horizon leveling, and motion compensation.
- **Higher Resolution Camera:** Upgrading to 1920×1080 would detect smaller objects at greater distances.
- **Multiple Object Tracking:** Enhance to support multiple simultaneous targets with priority-based tracking.
- **Deep Learning Optimization:** Migrate to YOLOv8n-int8 (8-bit quantized) for 3× faster performance.

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10. Appendix A – Major Code Listings

10.1 STM32 Main.c

```
/* ============================================================================
 * File: main.c
 * Description: Main program entry point and system initialization
 * ============================================================================ */

#include "main.h"
#include "string.h"
#include "stdio.h"

/* Private defines */
#define UART_RX_BUFFER_SIZE 64
#define SERVO_MIN_PULSE 500   // 0.5ms = 0 degrees
#define SERVO_MAX_PULSE 2500  // 2.5ms = 180 degrees
#define SERVO_PWM_PERIOD 20000 // 20ms period for 50Hz

/* Private variables */
UART_HandleTypeDef huart2;  // USB VCP for PC commands
UART_HandleTypeDef huart1;  // Bluetooth module
TIM_HandleTypeDef htim2;    // PWM timer for servos

uint8_t uart_rx_buffer[UART_RX_BUFFER_SIZE];
uint8_t uart_rx_byte;
uint8_t cmd_buffer[32];
uint8_t cmd_index = 0;
volatile uint8_t cmd_ready = 0;

uint16_t pan_angle = 90;   // Center position
uint16_t tilt_angle = 90;  // Center position

/* Private function prototypes */
void SystemClock_Config(void);
static void MX_GPIO_Init(void);
static void MX_USART2_UART_Init(void);
static void MX_USART1_UART_Init(void);
```

```c
static void MX_TIM2_Init(void);
void Process_Command(uint8_t *cmd);
void Set_Servo_Angle(uint8_t servo, uint16_t angle);
void Parse_PC_Command(uint8_t *buffer);
void Parse_BLE_Command(uint8_t *buffer);

/**
 * @brief  Main program entry point
 * @retval int
 */
int main(void)
{
  /* Reset of all peripherals, Initializes the Flash and Systick */
  HAL_Init();

  /* Configure the system clock to 2.097 MHz */
  SystemClock_Config();

  /* Initialize all configured peripherals */
  MX_GPIO_Init();
  MX_USART2_UART_Init();
  MX_USART1_UART_Init();
  MX_TIM2_Init();

  /* Start PWM generation for both servos */
  HAL_TIM_PWM_Start(&htim2, TIM_CHANNEL_1); // Pan servo (PA0)
  HAL_TIM_PWM_Start(&htim2, TIM_CHANNEL_2); // Tilt servo (PA1)

  /* Set servos to center position */
  Set_Servo_Angle(0, 90);  // Pan center
  Set_Servo_Angle(1, 90);  // Tilt center

  /* Enable UART receive interrupt */
  HAL_UART_Receive_IT(&huart2, &uart_rx_byte, 1);
  HAL_UART_Receive_IT(&huart1, &uart_rx_byte, 1);

  /* Transmit startup message */
  char msg[] = "Gimbal Control System Ready\r\n";
  HAL_UART_Transmit(&huart2, (uint8_t*)msg, strlen(msg), 100);

  /* Infinite loop */
  while (1)
  {
    /* Check if command is ready to process */
    if (cmd_ready)
    {
      Process_Command(cmd_buffer);
      cmd_ready = 0;
      cmd_index = 0;
      memset(cmd_buffer, 0, sizeof(cmd_buffer));
    }

    /* Small delay to prevent CPU spinning */
    HAL_Delay(1);
  }
}
```

```c
/**
 * @brief Process received command from UART
 * @param cmd: Command buffer to process
 */
void Process_Command(uint8_t *cmd)
{
  /* Determine command source and parse accordingly */
  if (cmd[0] == 'P' || cmd[0] == 'T')
  {
    /* PC command format: "P90T45\n" */
    Parse_PC_Command(cmd);
  }
  else if (cmd[0] == 'J' || cmd[0] == 'U' || cmd[0] == 'D' ||
           cmd[0] == 'L' || cmd[0] == 'R')
  {
    /* Bluetooth command format: "J120,75" or "U"/"D"/"L"/"R" */
    Parse_BLE_Command(cmd);
  }
}

/**
 * @brief Parse PC tracking commands
 * @param buffer: Command string (e.g., "P90T45")
 */
void Parse_PC_Command(uint8_t *buffer)
{
  uint16_t new_pan = pan_angle;
  uint16_t new_tilt = tilt_angle;
  char *ptr = (char *)buffer;

  /* Parse pan value */
  if (*ptr == 'P')
  {
    ptr++;
    new_pan = atoi(ptr);

    /* Find tilt command */
    while (*ptr && *ptr != 'T') ptr++;
  }

  /* Parse tilt value */
  if (*ptr == 'T')
  {
    ptr++;
    new_tilt = atoi(ptr);
  }

  /* Validate and update servo positions */
  if (new_pan >= 0 && new_pan <= 180)
  {
    pan_angle = new_pan;
    Set_Servo_Angle(0, pan_angle);
  }

  if (new_tilt >= 0 && new_tilt <= 180)
  {
    tilt_angle = new_tilt;
```

```
    Set_Servo_Angle(1, tilt_angle);
  }
}

/**
 * @brief Parse Bluetooth joystick/button commands
 * @param buffer: Command string (e.g., "J120,75" or "U")
 */
void Parse_BLE_Command(uint8_t *buffer)
{
  if (buffer[0] == 'J')
  {
    /* Joystick command: "J120,75" */
    int x_val, y_val;
    if (sscanf((char*)buffer, "J%d,%d", &x_val, &y_val) == 2)
    {
      /* Map joystick values (0-255) to servo angles (0-180) */
      pan_angle = (x_val * 180) / 255;
      tilt_angle = (y_val * 180) / 255;

      Set_Servo_Angle(0, pan_angle);
      Set_Servo_Angle(1, tilt_angle);
    }
  }
  else
  {
    /* D-pad button commands */
    switch(buffer[0])
    {
      case 'U': // Up - tilt up
        if (tilt_angle < 175) tilt_angle += 5;
        Set_Servo_Angle(1, tilt_angle);
        break;

      case 'D': // Down - tilt down
        if (tilt_angle > 5) tilt_angle -= 5;
        Set_Servo_Angle(1, tilt_angle);
        break;

      case 'L': // Left - pan left
        if (pan_angle > 5) pan_angle -= 5;
        Set_Servo_Angle(0, pan_angle);
        break;

      case 'R': // Right - pan right
        if (pan_angle < 175) pan_angle += 5;
        Set_Servo_Angle(0, pan_angle);
        break;
    }
  }
}

/**
 * @brief Set servo angle using PWM
 * @param servo: 0 = pan, 1 = tilt
 * @param angle: Desired angle (0-180 degrees)
 */
```

```c
void Set_Servo_Angle(uint8_t servo, uint16_t angle)
{
  /* Constrain angle to valid range */
  if (angle > 180) angle = 180;

  /* Calculate pulse width (500-2500us for 0-180 degrees) */
  uint16_t pulse_width = SERVO_MIN_PULSE +
                         ((angle * (SERVO_MAX_PULSE - SERVO_MIN_PULSE)) / 180);

  /* Update appropriate PWM channel */
  if (servo == 0)
  {
    /* Pan servo on TIM2 CH1 */
    __HAL_TIM_SET_COMPARE(&htim2, TIM_CHANNEL_1, pulse_width);
  }
  else if (servo == 1)
  {
    /* Tilt servo on TIM2 CH2 */
    __HAL_TIM_SET_COMPARE(&htim2, TIM_CHANNEL_2, pulse_width);
  }
}

/**
 * @brief UART Rx complete callback
 * @param huart: UART handle
 */
void HAL_UART_RxCpltCallback(UART_HandleTypeDef *huart)
{
  if (huart->Instance == USART2 || huart->Instance == USART1)
  {
    /* Check for command terminator */
    if (uart_rx_byte == '\n' || uart_rx_byte == '\r')
    {
      if (cmd_index > 0)
      {
        cmd_buffer[cmd_index] = '\0';
        cmd_ready = 1;
      }
    }
    else if (cmd_index < sizeof(cmd_buffer) - 1)
    {
      /* Add character to buffer */
      cmd_buffer[cmd_index++] = uart_rx_byte;
    }

    /* Re-enable receive interrupt */
    HAL_UART_Receive_IT(huart, &uart_rx_byte, 1);
  }
}
```

10.2 UART Interrupt Handlers

```c
/* ============================================================================
```

```
 * File: stm32l0xx_it.c
 * Description: Interrupt Service Routines
 * ========================================================================== */

/**
 * @brief USART2 global interrupt handler (PC communication)
 */
void USART2_IRQHandler(void)
{
  HAL_UART_IRQHandler(&huart2);
}

/**
 * @brief USART1 global interrupt handler (Bluetooth)
 */
void USART1_IRQHandler(void)
{
  HAL_UART_IRQHandler(&huart1);
}

/**
 * @brief TIM2 interrupt handler
 */
void TIM2_IRQHandler(void)
{
  HAL_TIM_IRQHandler(&htim2);
}
```

10.3 Python YOLO Tracking Systems

```
# ============================================================================
# PID Controller
# ============================================================================
class PIDController:
    """PID controller for smooth servo positioning"""
    def __init__(self, kp, ki, kd):
        self.kp = kp
        self.ki = ki
        self.kd = kd
        self.integral = 0
        self.prev_error = 0

    def compute(self, error, dt):
        """
        Compute PID output
        Args:
            error: Current error (target - actual)
            dt: Time delta since last update
        Returns:
            Control output
        """
        self.integral += error * dt
        derivative = (error - self.prev_error) / dt if dt > 0 else 0

        output = (self.kp * error +
```

```
                self.ki * self.integral +
                self.kd * derivative)

        self.prev_error = error
        return output

    def reset(self):
        """Reset controller state"""
        self.integral = 0
        self.prev_error = 0


# ============================================================================
# Serial Communication with Character-by-Character Transmission
# ============================================================================
def send_command_char_by_char(ser, command):
    """
    Send command one character at a time with delay
    Critical for STM32L0 @ 2.097 MHz to prevent buffer overflow

    Args:
        ser: Serial port object
        command: Command string to send
    """
    for char in command:
        ser.write(char.encode())
        time.sleep(CHAR_DELAY)
    ser.write(b'\n')
    time.sleep(CHAR_DELAY)


# ============================================================================
# Main Tracking System
# ============================================================================
class GimbalTracker:
    """Main person tracking system with YOLO and Kalman filtering"""

    def __init__(self):
        # Initialize YOLO model
        print("Loading YOLO model...")
        self.model = YOLO(MODEL_PATH)

        # Initialize serial connection
        print(f"Connecting to {SERIAL_PORT}...")
        try:
            self.serial = serial.Serial(SERIAL_PORT, BAUD_RATE, timeout=1)
            time.sleep(2)  # Wait for connection to stabilize
            print("Serial connection established")
        except serial.SerialException as e:
            print(f"Error opening serial port: {e}")
            raise

        # Initialize camera
        print("Initializing camera...")
        self.cap = cv2.VideoCapture(CAMERA_INDEX)
        self.cap.set(cv2.CAP_PROP_FRAME_WIDTH, FRAME_WIDTH)
        self.cap.set(cv2.CAP_PROP_FRAME_HEIGHT, FRAME_HEIGHT)
```

```
        if not self.cap.isOpened():
            raise RuntimeError("Failed to open camera")

        # Initialize tracking state
        self.kalman = KalmanFilter2D()
        self.pan_pid = PIDController(KP, KI, KD)
        self.tilt_pid = PIDController(KP, KI, KD)

        # Current servo positions (start centered)
        self.pan_angle = 90
        self.tilt_angle = 90

        # Timing
        self.last_command_time = 0
        self.last_frame_time = time.time()

        # ROI tracking
        self.roi_active = False
        self.roi_box = None
        self.frames_lost = 0
        self.max_frames_lost = 15

        print("Initialization complete!")

    def calculate_servo_angles(self, center_x, center_y):
        """
        Calculate required servo angles to center object

        Args:
            center_x: Object center X coordinate
            center_y: Object center Y coordinate
        Returns:
            (pan_angle, tilt_angle)
        """
        # Calculate error from frame center
        error_x = center_x - (FRAME_WIDTH / 2)
        error_y = center_y - (FRAME_HEIGHT / 2)

        # Convert pixel error to angle error
        # FOV assumptions: ~60 degrees horizontal, ~45 degrees vertical
        angle_per_pixel_x = 60.0 / FRAME_WIDTH
        angle_per_pixel_y = 45.0 / FRAME_HEIGHT

        dt = time.time() - self.last_frame_time

        # Use PID to compute angle adjustments
        pan_adjust = self.pan_pid.compute(error_x * angle_per_pixel_x, dt)
        tilt_adjust = self.tilt_pid.compute(error_y * angle_per_pixel_y, dt)

        # Update angles
        pan_angle = np.clip(self.pan_angle - pan_adjust, PAN_MIN, PAN_MAX)

        # CRITICAL: Invert tilt for correct servo direction
        tilt_angle = np.clip(180 - (self.tilt_angle - tilt_adjust),
                             TILT_MIN, TILT_MAX)
```

```
        return int(pan_angle), int(tilt_angle)

    def detect_person(self, frame):
        """
        Detect person in frame using YOLO

        Args:
            frame: Input frame
        Returns:
            Bounding box [x1, y1, x2, y2] or None if no detection
        """
        # Use ROI if active for faster processing
        if self.roi_active and self.roi_box is not None:
            x1, y1, x2, y2 = self.roi_box
            roi_frame = frame[y1:y2, x1:x2]
            results = self.model(roi_frame, conf=CONFIDENCE_THRESHOLD,
                                 verbose=False)
        else:
            results = self.model(frame, conf=CONFIDENCE_THRESHOLD,
                                 verbose=False)

        # Find person detections
        for result in results:
            boxes = result.boxes
            for box in boxes:
                if int(box.cls) == TARGET_CLASS:  # Person class
                    x1, y1, x2, y2 = box.xyxy[0].cpu().numpy()

                    # Adjust coordinates if using ROI
                    if self.roi_active and self.roi_box is not None:
                        roi_x1, roi_y1, _, _ = self.roi_box
                        x1 += roi_x1
                        x2 += roi_x1
                        y1 += roi_y1
                        y2 += roi_y1

                    return [int(x1), int(y1), int(x2), int(y2)]

        return None
```